



**SLOWLY, WITH YOU**

Written by

Thomas Sa and Claire Zhong

03/14/25

thomas.sa.screenwriting@gmail.com  
+1 343 209 3075

**SLOWLY, WITH YOU**

FADE IN:

INT. HIGH SCHOOL HALLWAY - MORNING

SUPER: 1998.

MI-NA (Asian, 18) stands curiously before an elongated school hallway. She glances around, both intrigued and slightly dismayed, as she searches for her new classroom.

Then, she notices a door leading to the school gym. As she walks toward it, she peers through the small window of the door... her gaze quickly lands on the stage inside...

MI-NA - V.O.

I remember the feeling of standing  
with the people I adored on stage,  
with dreams brighter than the  
spotlights illuminating my group  
and me. Nevertheless, while I  
cherish those moments, a part of me  
knows that I would never want to  
return to that past. I'm nothing  
more than a failed teen idol. The  
whole country knows it.

"You never had a future" ECHOES painfully in Mi-Na's head.

Shaking her head, she pulls herself away from prying at the windows and continues toward her class.

She quietly stands in front of the door, checking the number, before taking a deep breath and pushing it open.

INT. HIGH SCHOOL CLASSROOM - MORNING

There is a BOY (Asian, 18) standing with the TEACHER (40s). He also seems to be new just like her and gives her a small sense of reassurance.

Gently, she closes the door and walks towards the PODIUM.

Meanwhile, the students in the front rows WHISPER among themselves, turning their backs to Mi-Na before glancing at her, glaring, then turning back to snicker and whisper.

Paying them no mind for the time being, Mi-Na walks up beside the new guy and the teacher...

TEACHER

You must be Mi-Na. Nice to meet you. I am Mr. Smith, your homeroom teacher. And, oh right  
(turning to Ji-Won)  
Ji-Won is also new. He attended our school before, but he left a year ago and came back just today.

Ji-Won and Mi-Na exchange rigid and hushed "hi"s.

TEACHER (CONT'D)

The class will begin shortly, but first, I'll assign your seats. Ji-Won, you'll be sitting over there. And for you Mi-Na... please go sit in the empty seat between Ji-Won and the other male student, Jung-Won. Oh, and one last thing, a quick reminder that there are no bathrooms in this wing, so you'll need to use the ones in the next building. That's all.

Mi-Na silently nods and says a quiet "thank you." Once she heads towards the back of the class and walks between the lined desks, she can tell that word has gone around about her idol group. Their gazes seemingly never leave her.

With Ji-Won lagging behind, he notices her discomfort as gossip pours in from all sides and gently places a pair of HEADPHONES over her ears. Sentimental SONG begins playing... Startled, she turns back, only to look up to the new guy.

JI-WON

Just thought you'd be interested in listening to the new album.

MI-NA

What --

As he coldly places his CD Player in Mi-Na's hands...

JI-WON

-- Take my CD player and return it after school.

With that, Ji-Won strides toward JUNG-WON's (Asian, 18) desk, leaving Mi-Na standing behind in astonishment. Jung-Won, sitting at his desk, greets Ji-Won with a big smile and "Long time no see."

LATER.

Carefully setting down her bag, she takes a seat and takes out her school items, ignoring the entire class' look of mockery and their faces turned toward her.

Then, with a loud CHIME, the BELL RINGS. The students all sit down and upright to face the board.

Moments later, while she is attentively writing down notes, a little CRUMPLED-UP PIECE OF PAPER lands on her desk beside her hand. Stopping her writing, she turns towards where it came from and turns to face Jung-Won.

He smiles at her sweetly and makes a motion for her to open the paper and read it. Looking back at him, then back at the front of the class, she humors him and decides to open it. Quietly uncrumpling the ball, she reads its contents...

JUNG-WON - V.O.

Hey! You're new, right? I'm Jung-Won! Sorry to bother you, but can you pass this paper to the guy beside you? Thanks! - P.S. You're also pretty cute, care to join us for lunch today?

Beside the message was a little heart and kaomoji happy face.

Looking to the other side of Jung-Won, the new guy, Ji-Won, is writing down notes and seems to be erasing something.

Looking around, she waits until the teacher is facing the board before throwing the paper over toward the new guy.

As he looks up towards her to see where the paper came from, she gestures at him to open it and points to Jung-Won. He rolls his eyes before opening up the crumpled paper.

He takes a second to read the paper, his face contorting into different emotions as his eyes trail toward the end of it before he looks back up at Jung-Won, rolling his eyes.

He flips the piece of paper over and continues reading. Then he reaches into his bag for STICKY NOTES and starts scribbling before neatly folding one into a square and gently flinging it to her...

He emotionlessly stares at Mi-Na and nods towards Jung-Won prior to eyeing the paper he threw onto her desk.

Dreading where this would eventually lead up to, she rips off a SMALL PIECE OF PAPER and starts writing a message.

MI-NA - V.O.

First: Why would you invite me to lunch? Second: Sure I'll join you. Third: I'm not particularly sure I signed up to go to school to be two random guys' messengers. Figure something out that does not include me. - Mi-Na.

For extra effect, she decides to add a cute little heart beside the end of her message and a star beside her name. She clips it onto the other piece of paper thrown at her by the new guy and throws it to Jung-Won's desk...

TEACHER - O.S.

Mi-Na, pay attention! One more time, and I will ask you to step outside.

LATER.

As the SCHOOL BELL CHIMES, Mi-Na begins packing her belongings while Jung-Won and Ji-Won approach her desk.

JUNG-WON

Mi-Na, right? We're sorry for getting you scolded earlier.

JI-WON

We're? I think you mean you're sorry. I barely had anything to do with this.

MI-NA

It's fine. I wasn't bothered by the teacher anyway.

Jung-Won reaches into his pocket, before holding out a PUDDING to Mi-Na.

JUNG-WON

Consider it payment for your nonconsensual delivery service job.

MI-NA

You sure? You don't have to.

JUNG-WON

Just take it.

Mi-Na takes the pudding.

JUNG-WON (CONT'D)  
And, oh yeah, we're still having  
lunch together, right?

EXT. HIGH SCHOOL FIELDS - DAY

Mi-Na smirks as she takes her seat in front of Ji-Won and Jung-Won, who quietly begin setting the table with their food and cutlery. Meanwhile, Ji-Won, feeling shy around the new girl, avoids eye contact with her.

MI-NA  
You guys should really consider  
investing in a two-way pager and  
texting each other instead of  
tossing notes across the classroom.

JUNG-WON  
Nah, the papers have their charm.  
Also, if I or anyone else throwing  
them happen to hit him in the head,  
the trauma I inflict can be both  
physical AND mental.

Ji-Won turns to face his friend and smiles brightly.

JI-WON  
What trauma? I think the only  
trauma any one of us is getting is  
the fact that I'm STILL better than  
you at basketball.

Ji-Won smirks and Jung-Won's smile drops immediately,  
groaning and glaring at his friend.

JUNG-WON  
Stop bringing that up! I still  
don't understand how you can score  
from the other side of the field  
with such a scrawny build.

JI-WON  
Makes it all the more sad for you.  
Boohoo.

JUNG-WON  
I- You!

At a loss for words, Jung-Won admits defeat and slumps before  
taking another bite of his lunch.

JI-WON

By the way, do you not have a lunch?

MI-NA

(opening her pudding)

Oh, I forgot to make myself one this morning. I'll probably just have a big meal once I get home. Also, Jung-Won, your bento box.

She points at the light PASTEL PINK BENTO BOX.

JUNG-WON

What about it?

MI-NA

It's so cute.

JUNG-WON

Oh, thanks. It's on sale right now. I can tell you where to buy it. They're also selling it with a deal for extra cups and lunch stuff, too. I recommend it, it's great!

Mi-Na's face lights up as she excitedly leans forward.

MI-NA

Woah, really!? You have to tell me where you bought it.

JUNG-WON

(smiling)

It was the corner store beside our school. If I remember correctly, I also saw some Hello Kitty earphones on another aisle that's on sale, too!

Jung-Won continues to take a bite of his lunch.

JI-WON

This is the third lunchbox you've bought, how do your parents still give you access to all your money?

JUNG-WON

Cause I'm filthy rich and privileged like that.

He haughtily raises his voice and takes out a \$5 BILL to fan himself mockingly. As a result, Ji-Won groans and rolls his eyes with a fond smile before continuing to eat.

Then, Ji-Won notices that Mi-Na has been poking at the pudding for the past ten minutes without actually eating it.

JI-WON

Is there something wrong with the pudding?

MI-NA

No there's nothing wrong with it. It's just that I was never allowed to eat anything other than chicken breasts and celery sticks for most of my life.

JUNG-WON

How do you even gain the energy to run around a big stage with that amount of food?

MI-NA

Honestly, every meal just barely gets me through a performance. The rest is pure muscle memory from all the training.

The school BELL RINGS.

MI-NA (CONT'D)

We better hurry. Sorry for suddenly unloading my trauma on you guys.

JUNG-WON

(smiling)

Oh, no problem. We, at least I, didn't mind it at all. Come to me whenever you need to talk.

JI-WON

Yeah, I didn't mind it either.

INT. BASKETBALL COURT - DAY

Jung-Won, panting, lies on the cold basketball court, drained from his last match. Ji-Won carefully sits beside him, seemingly less exhausted.

JUNG-WON

You've gotten better, Ji-Won. Before you left, you couldn't even score a point against me!

Ji-Won playfully punches Jung-Won's lower abdomen.



JUNG-WON (CONT'D)

Ow! How could you punch your best friend in the stomach like that!? I practically almost beat you! A punch to the stomach is a terrible second-place award.

JI-WON

It was 2 to 5, to be exact. Also, you got second AND last place.

JUNG-WON

Pfft, they're practically the same thing. Don't be so uptight!

(beat)

Also, didn't you tell me two years ago that you had a crush on someone? What happened to that?

JI-WON

Oh yeah. It was my internet pen pal. But it's been such a long time since we last spoke. Besides, we never even met in person.

JUNG-WON

What about now? Do you want me to set you up with someone?

JI-WON

Fuck no.

JUNG-WON

Why so opposed to the idea, huh?

Jung-Won starts playfully tickling Ji-Won like a sibling, and as Ji-Won tries to retaliate, both of them lose their balance, with Ji-Won falling on top of Jung-Won.

JUNG-WON (CONT'D)

(poking Ji-Won's heart  
with his finger)

Woah...

Ji-Won bounds up, running to the side of the court, and starts feigning RETCHING gestures and NOISES.

JUNG-WON (CONT'D)

(laughing hysterically)

You fell for that.

JI-WON

(spitting)

You crazy bastard.

Nonetheless, eventually, Ji-Won reciprocates with a smile.

INT. HIGH SCHOOL LIBRARY

While Ji-Won is picking out books, he notices Mi-Na sleeping with her head resting on a hard surface. The following voiceover plays over the actions...

JI-WON - V.O.

The truth is, I was already  
strangely drawn to someone. Mi-Na.  
When I heard she'd lived on chicken  
breasts and celery, I felt both  
concerned and oddly... angry. I  
wanted to cook for her. I wanted to  
be the first to show her what real  
food tastes like...

Passing by, he removes his JACKET, places it on her back, and unwraps his SCARF to provide a cushion for her head.

JI-WON - V.O. (CONT'D)

...But soon after, we became quite  
close.

CUT TO:

BEGIN WATERCOLOR-INSPIRED ANIMATED MONTAGE.

INT. JI-WON'S ROOM - DAY

Mi-Na paces around the room, waving her arms and rattling on about her latest woes.

MI-NA

Oh my gosh. That teacher was  
literally my worst nightmare. He  
would not give ANY good  
explanations; it was horrible. I  
swear, if I ever get him as a  
teacher again, I am going to drop  
out of school and --

Her speech continues... Forgotten pieces of homework lay abandoned on the table between them as Ji-Won absentmindedly listens with a BOOK in hand, resting atop his bed.

MI-NA (CONT'D)

-- Isn't that crazy?! Oh yeah!  
Also, have you seen my jacket  
anywhere? I swear I left it here...

Mi-Na walks around Ji-Won's room, lifting countless items and peeking underneath them while searching for her jacket.

Ji-Won, without lifting his head from his book, points outside where her BLACK JACKET hangs from a clothing line.

JI-WON

I washed it while you were taking a nap and it's still drying right now. By the time you go back, it'll probably be dry.

Ji-Won flips a page and continues reading.

Mi-Na is rendered slightly speechless as she gazes at him with her mouth slightly open before promptly shaking herself out of it.

MI-NA

Whoa, thanks! You didn't have to wash it, y'know; I could've done that myself.

She stops pacing and sits back down on the opposite side of the table, in front of her countless worksheets strewn across the desk, staring at Ji-Won, reading, as she settles down.

JI-WON

Mmmm, well, the opportunity was there, and I took it. And honestly, it felt kind of awkward not to do anything either.

He looks up from his book to stare back at Mi-Na, who is sitting across from him. The sweater swings back and forth outside, blocking the sun and casting a drifting shadow over both of them. The orange hue of the sunset highlights Mi-Na's best features.

JI-WON (CONT'D)

Your eyes are really bright.

He says out of the blue, smiling at her as he puts his book down.

MI-NA

What's with all the compliments today, hm? Are my answers on those homework sheets that bad?

Mi-Na smirks back at him and grabs her scribbled-on worksheet.

JI-WON  
Can't I compliment my friend a  
little bit? I have duties to  
uphold.

He pauses for a second, smiling back at Mi-Na, who is still  
staring at her paper.

JI-WON (CONT'D)  
Oh yeah, and you got question 15  
wrong.

LATER.

MI-NA  
Hey, do you mind if I stop by the  
grocery store later when we head  
back? I need to pick up a few  
things for my mom.

EXT. CITY PARK - DAY

Mi-Na reaches up to a nearby tree and plucks a bright red  
maple leaf as they walk past it, spinning it by the stem  
between her fingers. The sunlight filters through the canopy  
of red leaves, casting a light red hue on them and the  
winding path ahead.

She raises her other hand to block the sunlight hitting her  
eyes when a sudden bright flash of light and the sound of a  
CAMERA SHUTTER SNAP behind her.

Ji-Won walks a little behind her before jogging to catch up,  
CAMERA in hand.

MI-NA  
Hey!

She yells at him, stopping to wait for him to catch up beside  
her.

MI-NA (CONT'D)  
What was that for?

She continues along the path with Ji-Won, his camera swiftly  
tucked back into his pocket.

JI-WON  
Just thought you looked nice.

He replies curtly, shoving his hand back into his pocket  
before taking it out again.

JI-WON (CONT'D)

Wanna see?

He presses a few buttons, turning the camera back on. They both stop in the middle of the path, with Mi-Na leaning over his forearm to see the picture.

His shirt sleeves are rolled back slightly, revealing his forearms, and his shirt is loosened by one button so as to display his collarbones...

MI-NA - V.O.

You smell so good. Why are you so good at arousing people? It should be a crime to be this perfect. Do you even know how much I get jealous of you? I feel so pathetic when I get jealous of people I don't even know who stare at you.

She looks ethereal; the sun hits her just the right angles, the red and orange hues of the backdrop contrast stunningly with her black outfit, and the carefree expression on her face is crafted to perfection.

MI-NA

Whoa! That's actually a really good photo!

(scrutinizing)

...better than all of my photos from my old model shoots.

She snatches the camera from him, zooming in and out as if she can't believe it's her in the photo.

JI-WON

Best one so far... There's still time for a better one though...

He shoves his hands back into his pockets now that the camera isn't in his hands anymore.

MI-NA

So far? There's more?!

Mi-Na rapidly starts scrolling through the other pictures, taking a good look at each one in shock.

JI-WON

(proud, clearing his throat)

(MORE)

JI-WON (CONT'D)

Hey, if you're gonna look at  
photos, we might as well sit down  
and do it, instead of standing in  
the middle of the path.

Ji-Won exclaims, tugging at Mi-Na's arm and dragging her to a nearby bench. He carefully sits her down while she attentively keeps scrolling through the photos.

JI-WON - V.O.

I wish I had another camera to take  
another picture of her. This angle  
would be perfect.

Mi-Na continues scrolling, eventually stopping to carefully inspect each photo in an attempt to count how many pictures there were of her on the camera.

There are photos of her dozing off at school, at her house, and from a distance; the camera roll just never ends.

She realizes there isn't a single picture of Ji-Won himself, and carefully, she brings the maple leaf she still holds in her hand into his hair and snaps a quick photo of him.

JI-WON

H-hey- what?

Blinded by the sudden flash, he instinctively brings his hand up to his face to block the blinding light. Before he opens his eyes again, he hears Mi-Na lightly giggling at him and the subtle sound of clicking camera buttons.

She tugs at his hand, urging him to open his eyes again. Slowly, he brings his hand back down and opens his eyes to find himself face to face with a picture of himself, a bright red maple leaf nestled in his hair...

He reaches up to find the leaf gingerly resting atop his hair like a boat on water. He stares at it for a moment before bringing his gaze back down to meet Mi-Na's eyes.

MI-NA

Just thought you looked nice.

She replies curtly, taking the camera for herself and slipping it into her own pocket.

END WATERCOLOR-INSPIRED ANIMATED MONTAGE.

CUT TO:

INT. HIGH SCHOOL CLASSROOM - DAY

Ji-Won excitedly runs towards Mi-Na with a giant smile and shows her a BUSINESS CARD.

JI-WON

Look! I saw an entertainment company executive standing outside the school, and he asked me to give this to you. He said he's willing to let you train under him! I think he's super --

Suddenly, Mi-Na's smile evaporates.

JI-WON (CONT'D)

-- Is there something wrong?

"You never had a future" echoes in her head.

JI-WON (CONT'D)

A-are you okay?

Mi-Na stands up with the brutal noise of her chair legs dragging across the floor. A rush of emotions slips into her mind as she stands frozen.

"You never had a future, you were never good enough" resonates louder in her brain. It echoes again and again.

She snatches the paper from Ji-Won, violently crumpling it and angrily hurling it across the room.

Her classmates all begin to stray away from their textbooks and shift their attention to Mi-Na and Ji-Won. They gossip in incoherent whispers, saying something along the lines of, "No wonder she was fired; she has an ass personality."

A symphony of LOUD CAMERA CLICKS from reporters pounds traumatically in Mi-Na's ears as she desperately covers them. The world around Mi-Na is in a total glitch as she stands idly in a state of pure paralysis.

MI-NA

Why the fuck would you bring me that!?

(beat, hands trembling)

...You're just like everyone else, trying to get me back in the industry that I despise. You don't know anything.

With more conspicuous whispers of insults, rumors, and speculation circulating around her, she struggles to breathe, barely managing to take in her next breath.

MI-NA (CONT'D)  
(realizing, stuttering)  
I- I'm s- sorry.

But, then and there, Ji-Won advances in Mi-Na's direction, swallowing her into his embrace and rubbing her back in a back-and-forth movement.

MUSIC CUE: "endless shine" by Sherman Zhou (OST PART 1).

As Mi-Na snuggles her arms around Ji-Won's waist, their warmth lolls against each other's skin. Her face nestled and hidden by her friend's embrace, Ji-Won is Mi-Na's protectorate from the gaze of the public.

Seconds elapse and silence between them pursues.

JI-WON  
You're right; I don't understand anything. So, rather than offering you empty words, I'll hug you.  
(patting her back)  
You don't have to feel okay. It's okay to be sad sometimes. It's okay to be stressed. Everything you're feeling right now is valid.

MI-NA - V.O.  
His embrace was warm and fuzzy. It was comforting. With his embrace, the world around me became static and the wild cacophony turned into a deafening silence.

JI-WON  
You're not alone. I'm always there for you. Like this.  
(beat)  
This won't do it. Let's flee.

He captures Mi-Na's wrist, storming out of the classroom...

EXT. CITY PARK - DAY

They race along park paths, a shower of cherry blossoms following their every stride and framing their every move.



JI-WON - V.O.  
That's when I realized. That she  
was my first love.

After helping Mi-Na settle onto a bench, Ji-Won runs off to somewhere mysterious. Meanwhile, Mi-Na takes a moment alone to compose herself.

Ji-Won returns with an ICE CREAM, almost comically oversized and absurdly big. He kneels to her level and hands it to her... But as Mi-Na excitedly leans forward to take a bite, Ji-Won suddenly jumps in and takes a massive bite himself.

MI-NA  
(stunned)  
Hey!

Mischievously, he looks up, only to lock eyes with Mi-Na. His expression turns stern as he realizes that their faces are only an inch apart... perfect kissing distance.

Ji-Won's gaze slowly flits from Mi-Na's eyes to her lips, his throat working as he nervously swallows the cold lump of ice cream. Mi-Na's focus trails down to Ji-Won's lips, glistening faintly with a smear of cream.

Then, Ji-Won's gaze returns to her eyes, meeting hers for a fleeting moment before they both abruptly look away with cheeks burning with embarrassment.

Awkwardly, he reveals ANOTHER ICE CREAM CONE concealed behind his back and hands it to her.

JI-WON  
Here. I was just playing with you.  
I hope you feel better.

MI-NA  
(flustered)  
Oh. Thank you.

He sits next to her, and as a moment of silence deluges between the two of them, he breaks it with a soft "ahem."

MI-NA (CONT'D)  
(licking her ice cream)  
Yeah?

JI-WON  
I'm not sure if this helps, but I  
used to do taekwondo. After my mom  
lost to cancer, I gave it up. It  
kept reminding me of how abusive my  
father was.  
(MORE)

JI-WON (CONT'D)

Eventually, I realized the sport itself wasn't wrong. I was letting the bad memories get to me. So, Mi-Na, don't let your passion be tainted by your past.

MI-NA

(upon reflection)

They say comparison is the thief of joy. I was always measured against an ocean of pretty people. I think I let that dull my passion. Maybe I started to hate myself because I kept doing it too: comparing myself. But you're right. I shouldn't let my passion be spoiled by what happened in the past.

Ji-Won and Mi-Na offer each other faint and gentle smiles.

MI-NA (CONT'D)

If you ever go back to taekwondo, I'll be there to cheer you on.

JI-WON

And I'll be there, cheering for you too - whatever you decide to do.

INT. THEATRE - DAY

LIGHTS illuminate the stage, where Mi-Na elegantly stands. Her legs slowly gravitate toward the front with decisive steps as dreamy piano music prevails in the background.

MI-NA - V.O.

Then... Three months later... For the second time in my life, I decided to take courage.

Ji-Won's FOOTSTEPS RESONATING as they persevere toward the entrance of the theater... Pushing open the doors... Holding a bouquet in hand... He smiles.

INT. HIGH SCHOOL HALLWAY/CLASSROOM - DAY

SUPER: EPILOGUE. 1 YEAR LATER.

Mi-Na fiddles with her phone, walking in an empty corridor.

MI-NA

(mumbling to herself)

Today's the day...

Then, typing a mysterious number, she begins to CALL...

MEANWHILE. Empty classroom. With only Ji-Won in the room, wet, he begins to unbutton his collared shirt... BUZZ of a RINGING PHONE that vibrates in his pocket...

He pauses, reading the number displayed on his phone.

JI-WON  
Oh shit, it's today.  
(picking up)  
Hello, this is Ji --

MI-NA  
(walking inside the  
classroom)  
-- Hi? Hello?

Her "hi" and "hello" echo from the phone Ji-Won is holding-

MI-NA (CONT'D)  
My internet pen pal? USER FLYING  
SQUIRREL?

She's left in pure astonishment. Silence elapsed. Both of their faces reveal paralyzing shock.

A realization strikes Mi-Na, and she finds herself repelled by Ji-Won's shirtless state. Overwhelmed, she jolts out of the classroom, slamming the wooden sliding door behind her.

MI-NA (CONT'D)  
(leaning against the door,  
heavy breaths)  
Why are you... How... Is that your  
phone? Are you user flyingsquirrel?  
I'm cosmicadventures.

JI-WON  
Yeah...

MI-NA  
That means... you're the one who told  
me to go to the beach when I lost  
that audition... and you're the one  
who stayed up all night --

JI-WON  
-- doing your geography essay till  
3 am in middle school.

MI-NA

Oh... A-also, why are you soaked? And changing here? In our old classroom in the old wing of the school?

JI-WON

It's the day before graduation, so I was skipping class with Jung-Won in the garden... Then that idiot sprayed me with a hose, so I came here to change since this wing is practically abandoned and I figured I'd be safe down here from being caught skipping. Why are YOU here?

MI-NA

I.. uh.. just heard this place is getting demolished soon, so I wanted to revisit it before we graduate tomorrow. It's where I had my first moments here.

JI-WON

Oh...

She notices a silhouette of an adult figure marching...

MI-NA

Hold on. I think it's the new custodian! Open the door, I don't wanna be punished. We're both not supposed to be here.

JI-WON

What!? - Why's he even --

Mi-Na tries pushing, harder with each failed attempt, grunting as the wooden sliding door sticks in its track.

But then, Ji-Won, with his drenched white shirt loosely draping over his torso, tugs the door open all of a sudden, causing Mi-Na to YELP and land on the surface of his chest... He takes her by the waist, pulling her further into his embrace, to allow room for the door to close behind her.

JI-WON (CONT'D)

(placing his palm over  
Mi-Na's mouth)

Shhh. Be quiet. He's walking by.

They remain in their uncomfortable positions as their heartbeat picks up, pounding in increasing rhythm.

JI-WON (CONT'D)

You can move now. He's gone.

Mi-Na stutters backward, before bumping into the door. Her gaze is fixed on Ji-Won, especially his eyes, while the silence grows between them.

JI-WON (CONT'D)

There's something that I've been wanting to confirm. Are you actually dating that guy you have dating rumors with, or is it just internet gossip? I swear it takes less time for the news to update your dating scandals than it takes my teacher to update my mark.

MI-NA

What!? No, that's just my agency trying to generate buzz on the internet with my name, so I get attention. And, people like that kinda --

JI-WON

-- That's all I needed to hear.

Hesitantly, Ji-Won stares down at Mi-Na. His whole face is tinged pink, and his hands gently grab her by the shoulders.

JI-WON (CONT'D)

..because I really like you, Mi-Na.

Mi-Na stares back at Ji-Won, his face still pink. She opens her mouth, then closes it a few times, shocked by what just happened and unsure of what to say. Finally, after an eternity, Mi-Na smiles at him and gently lifts his hands from her shoulders, holding them in her own.

MI-NA

I really appreciate everything you've done to help me. Honestly, if I hadn't met you as a pen pal when I was just a child that was being forced by my parents to become a star for the family... I don't think I would be standing with you today. You have been one of the most important people in my life, both now and then, and I think of you as more than a friend.

With silence accumulating between them, they exchange embarrassed glances. At a loss for what to do next...

JI-WON  
(clears throat, quietly)  
C-Can I kiss you?

MI-NA  
(laughing, smirks)  
What? Say it louder. I couldn't  
hear you.

Ji-Won hesitates, face fuming with embarrassment, then speaks slightly louder, but still rushed, almost mumbling.

JI-WON  
Can I kiss you?

Followed by Mi-Na's soft "yeah," Ji-Won's head inches closer to hers, leaning in for a kiss as his hands rise gently to cup her cheeks. Noticing that Ji-Won is wet from the rain...

MI-NA  
Are you cold?

JI-WON  
Not when I'm with you.

She shuts her eyes and Ji-Won's lips are already on hers. As the romance gradually consumes their eyes and hearts, we...

FADE OUT.

END OF FILM.